

Mathematics

Year 3

Cambridge Early Years

Student Manual



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British English edition.

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INTRODUCTION

How this book works

In this first unit you will count in ones, tens and hundreds, find out what each digit in a three-digit number is really worth, and put numbers in order with confidence.

How to help

- **Work together.** Read the page aloud, then let your child lead.
- **Talk lots.** The questions start conversations, they do not test.
- **Keep it fun.** Short, happy sessions beat long, tired ones.

A note for grown-ups

This book follows the spirit of an international primary programme, interpreted afresh for Prime School. Every unit grows new skills out of a topic children already care about, and finishes with something to make, draw or write.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Reading the page

Each section follows the same rhythm, so you always know where you are.

PANEL	WHAT IT DOES
In this unit, you will	The goals for the unit.
Let us start	A quick warm-up to wake up what you know.
Listening and speaking	Talk and listen about the topic.
Vocabulary	Learn new words, with pictures.
Remember!	A reminder of something you already learned.
Word book	Write down new words to keep.
Thinking time	A question to think and talk about.
I can	Statements to check your progress.

How to work

Take your time and look at the pictures: they are there to help you. When you see a new word, say it out loud. In Talking time there are no wrong answers, only good ideas.

GETTING READY

Before Unit 1

You do not need much: a pencil, some crayons, a notebook, and someone to work with.

Your toolkit

- Your eyes, for looking carefully at the pictures.
- Your voice, for reading out loud and sharing ideas.
- Your notebook, for writing and drawing what you find.

A little warm-up

- 1 What do you already know about this topic?
- 2 What would you most like to find out?
- 3 Who could you ask if you got stuck?

These are exactly the things Unit 1 will help you with. When you can answer them, you are ready to begin.

UNIT 1

1

Numbers and the number system

Hundreds, tens and ones

© IN THIS UNIT, YOU WILL

- ✓ Count on and back in ones, tens and hundreds.
- ✓ Say what each digit in a three-digit number is worth.
- ✓ Compare and order three-digit numbers.
- ✓ Continue number sequences and explain the rule.

◆ LET US START

Count in tens from 100 to 200. Now count in hundreds from 100 to 900. Which counting was faster? Talk to a partner about why.

UNIT 1 • PART 1

Counting and sequences

A **sequence** is a list of numbers that follows a rule.

In 15, 20, 25, the rule is "add 5", so the next two numbers are 30 and 35.

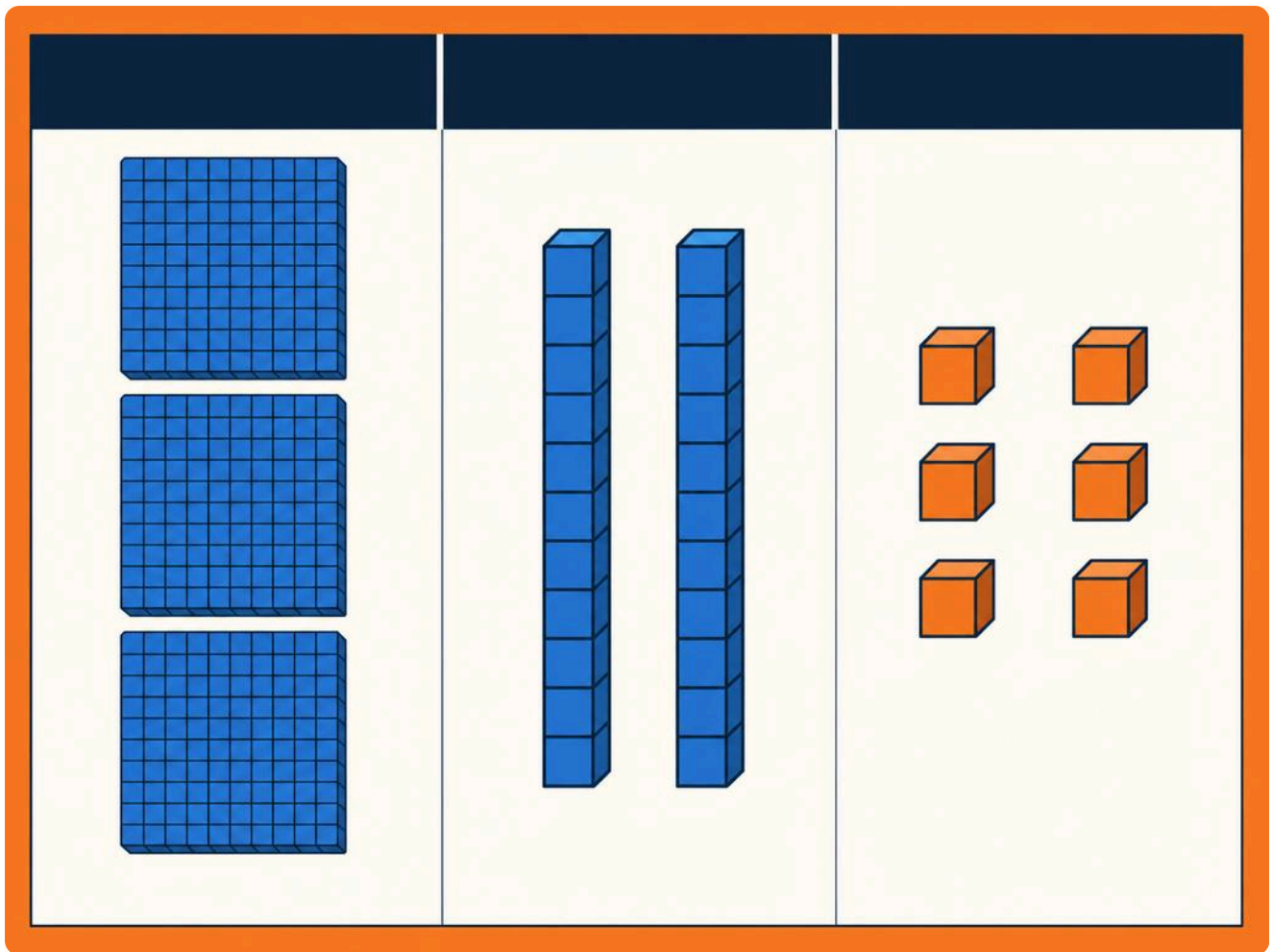
- 1 Find the rule and write the next two numbers.
 - a. 10, 20, 30, 40, ____, ____
 - b. 100, 200, 300, ____, ____
 - c. 50, 45, 40, 35, ____, ____
- 2 Count on in fifties from 150. Say the first six numbers.
- 3 Make a sequence of your own that goes down. Give it to a partner.

UNIT 1 • PART 2

Place value

In a three-digit number, each digit has a **value**.

In 326 there are 3 hundreds, 2 tens and 6 ones, because $300 + 20 + 6 = 326$.



Picture 1 Hundreds, tens and ones in 326.

 REMEMBER!

The place of a digit tells you its value. The 3 in 326 is worth 300, not 3.

- 1 What is each digit worth?
a. 415 b. 708 c. 260
- 2 Write these as hundreds, tens and ones:
a. 573 b. 904
- 3 Write the number that is made of 6 hundreds, 0 tens and 9 ones.

UNIT 1 • PART 3

Comparing and ordering

- 1 Which is bigger? Explain how you know.
a. 219 or 291 b. 480 or 408
- 2 Put these in order, smallest first: 219, 192, 291.
- 3 Write a number between 350 and 400.

◆ THINKING TIME

How does knowing place value help you compare two numbers quickly?

☑ SUMMARY CHECKLIST

- ✓ I can count on and back in ones, tens and hundreds.
- ✓ I can say what each digit is worth.
- ✓ I can compare and order three-digit numbers.
- ✓ I can continue a sequence and explain its rule.

UNIT 1 • FINAL PROJECT

The number museum

★ FINAL PROJECT

The number museum

Your group will create a 'number museum' exhibit for one three-digit number of your choice. Show what each digit is worth, in as many different ways as you can.

What to hand in

- Your exhibit, showing hundreds, tens and ones.
- The number written in words and in figures.
- A sequence that includes your number, with its rule.

How it will be judged

Criterion	Weight	--- ---	Correct place value	40%	Variety of representations	30%	Correct sequence and rule	20%	Presentation	10%
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UNIT 1 • CHECK YOUR PROGRESS

- 1 What is each digit worth in 415?
- 2 Write 573 as hundreds, tens and ones.
- 3 Which is bigger, 219 or 291? How do you know?
- 4 Put these in order, smallest first: 219, 192, 291.
- 5 Write the next two numbers: 50, 45, 40, 35, ____, ____
- 6 Write a number between 350 and 400.

UNIT 1 • EVALUATION

Be honest. Colour the circle that matches how you feel about each outcome: green means confident, amber means nearly there, red means needs more work.

I CAN ...	GREEN	AMBER	RED
count on and back in ones, tens and hundreds	☐	☐	☐
say what each digit is worth	☐	☐	☐
compare and order three-digit numbers	☐	☐	☐
continue a sequence and explain its rule	☐	☐	☐

UNIT 1 • WHAT CAN YOU DO?

✓ WHAT CAN YOU DO?

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Count on and back in ones, tens and hundreds. | ☐ Compare and order three-digit numbers. |
| ☐ Say what each digit in a number is worth. | ☐ Continue a sequence and explain its rule. |

GLOSSARY

Unit 1

sequence: a list of numbers that follows a rule.

place value: what a digit is worth because of its position.

digit: one of the symbols 0 to 9.

hundreds: groups of one hundred in a number.

SOURCES & REFERENCES

Where everything came from

All text and diagrams are original to this edition. The factual claims can be checked here. Links were live as of July 2026.

§ UNIT 1 • NUMBERS AND THE NUMBER SYSTEM

- 1 **Place value and sequences. The teaching sequence follows established primary-number practice.**

Hundreds, tens and ones.

This Year 3 Student Book makes place value click. You will count in hundreds, work out what every digit is worth, compare three-digit numbers, and explain the rule in any sequence.

Written for Prime School pupils, in clear British English, with every answer checked by computer.

COUNTING

PLACE VALUE

SEQUENCES

ORDERING